Session 2: Emerging Markets and Developing Economies

Background: AI is already transforming the global economy. For emerging markets and developing economies (EMDEs), it remains uncertain whether AI will foster greater prosperity or widen the gap with advanced economies. EMDEs occupy diverse positions in global technology value chains, but many face common obstacles to beneficial adoption, including limited access to capital and key infrastructure (e.g., electricity, internet, compute). Although EMDEs may be less exposed to AI-induced job displacement overall, they could be particularly vulnerable in growth-driving sectors such as business-process outsourcing. The policy choices facing governments are increasingly complex as they weigh these considerations against the broader national security landscape influencing AI policy.

Lead speakers:

S. Krishnan, Secretary of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Government of India

Bosun Tijani, Minister of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy of the Federal Republic of Nigeria

Zeine Zeidane, Director of the African Department of the IMF, former Prime Minister of Mauritania

Focus: The discussions would focus on the following questions[1]:
(1) Where is AI adoption in EMDEs delivering progress, and where is it not?
(2) What are the most important macro risks for EMDEs?
(3) How should EMDEs navigate labor market disruptions and preserve viable growth models?

Outcomes: (1) A clearer understanding of the distinctive constraints and opportunities that shape AI deployment in EMDEs. (2) A shared assessment of the main macroeconomic and financial risks, including where policy action is most urgent. (3) Policy priorities for supporting sustainable growth.

[1] The questions below are illustrative and intended to help speakers and participants frame the discussion; they are not exhaustive.